

A

What dictionaries do I need?

A **bilingual** dictionary [using two languages] is easy for you to understand, and quick and easy to use. A dictionary in English will give you reading practice in English and many more examples of how words are used. If possible, use both. These are good dictionaries in English for your level, and most of them are available online:

Cambridge Learner's Dictionary
Longman Active Study Dictionary

Oxford Wordpower Dictionary
Macmillan Essential Dictionary

B

Information in dictionaries

If you **look up a word** [find a word in a dictionary] using the *Cambridge Learner's Dictionary*, the information is shown like this:

pronunciation using **phonemic symbols** (see page 247)

a **definition** explains the meaning

bold italics show common word partners (see Unit 74)

fun¹
/fʌn/ noun [u]

1 enjoyment or pleasure, or something that gives you enjoyment or pleasure

*She's **great fun** to be with.*

***Have fun!** (= enjoy yourself)*

*It's **no fun** having to work late every night.*

2 **for fun/for the fun of it** for pleasure and not for any other reason

3 **make fun of sb/sth** to make a joke about someone or something in an unkind way.

*The other children at school used to **make fun of** his hair.*

part of speech (= noun)

[U] tells you that *fun* is uncountable (see Unit 86)

fixed phrases using the word are shown in **bold** (see Units 75–6)

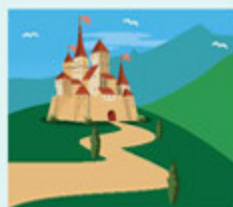
examples are in *italics*

3.1 Correct the spelling mistakes. Use a dictionary to check your answers.

- | | |
|-------------------------------|----------------------|
| 1 allways <i>always</i> | 6 confortable |
| 2 realy | 7 accomodation |
| 3 unfortunatly | 8 beautifull |
| 4 expecially | 9 unbeleivable |
| 5 cloths | 10 neccesary |

3.2 In the word *island* /'aɪlənd/, the letter 's' is silent (not pronounced). Use your dictionary to find the silent letters in these words.

- | | | | | |
|--------|--------|----------|----------|-----------|
| 1 knee | 2 comb | 3 castle | 4 salmon | 5 receipt |
|--------|--------|----------|----------|-----------|


C

Defining words

'Defining words' are words that dictionaries use when they **define** [explain] the words in the dictionary. Some of these are quite common.

emphasise [give something more attention and importance], e.g. My teacher has always emphasised the importance of writing down new words in a notebook.

relating to or **connected to/with** [having a relationship with someone or something], e.g. *musical* is connected with / related to *music*

amount [how much there is of something], e.g. £5 million is a large amount of money.

official [done by the government or someone in authority], e.g. A passport is an official document.

behave [do or say things in a particular way], e.g. People can behave strangely when they're nervous.